How to Use JR Hokkaido

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Ticket Changes and Refunds

Types of Tickets

- A basic fare ticket is required for boarding.
- All seats are reserved on all JR Hokkaido's limited express trains. For boarding, a "reserved seat limited express ticket" or "vacant seat only ticket" is required in addition to a basic fare ticket (※1). (※1) IC cards can be used as a basic fare ticket only when both the departure and arrival stations are within the same IC card area. Click here for details.
- Sightseeing trains with all seats reserved (Furano Biei Norokko Train, Kushiro Shitsugen Norokko Train, SL Fuyu-no-Shitsugen Train): A "reserved seat ticket" is required in addition to a basic fare ticket. IC cards cannot be used.
- Rapid Airport, Ryuhyo Monogatari Train: For reserved seats, a "reserved seat ticket" is required in addition to a basic fare ticket (※2). (※2) IC cards can be used as a basic fare ticket only on the Rapid Airport.

Ticket Types

Train Types in Hokkaido	Stops
Local train	Every station
Rapid train	Skips some stations
Rapid Airport (Semi-Rapid/Special Rapid)	Skips some stations
Limited express train	Major stations
Shinkansen	Shinkansen stations

*1 Green cars are available only on the Soya, Sarobetsu, Hokuto, Tokachi, Ozora, and Lilac services. They may not be available if there are car changes.

★Vacant seat only ticket : You need to decide the boarding date and section but not train and seat number. Any vacant seats (only in ordinary cars) on your desired train can be used temporarily. If a passenger with a reserved seat ticket for that seat comes, you must move to another seat.
The price of the vacant seat only ticket is the same as that of the reserved seat limited express ticket. If you decide the boarding time before boarding, you can reserve a seat without additional charge by reserved seat ticket vending machine etc. (Only if there are vacant seats)
You may need to stand if seats are full. (Refunds cannot be made for the reason that seats are full)

Car Formation (Example)

Long Distance (Sapporo - Kushiro, etc.) Limited Express Train



Short Distance (Sapporo - Asahikawa, etc.) Limited Express Train



Local/Rapid Train (Some trains have reserved seats)

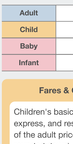


Car Types of Limited Express Train

There are two types of car: Ordinary and Green.

The difference between Ordinary and Green cars is…

Green cars have wider seats for a more comfortable and relaxing trip.



Reserved Seat
Because the date, train, departure time, arrival time, and seat number are determined, a seat is guaranteed.

Non-reserved Seat
Available on local and rapid trains. You can travel without selecting a specific train or seat.

Passenger Classification

Adult	Ages 12 and older
Child	Ages 6 through 11
Baby	Ages 1 through 5
Infant	Less than 1 year old

Fares & Charges for Children

Children's basic fare, limited express, express, and reserved seat tickets are 50% of the adult price (fractions under ¥10 are rounded down). Green car, sleeper car, and numbered tickets are the same as the adult price.

Fares & Charges for Babies/Infants

Though babies and infants travel for free, a child ticket is required in the following cases.

1. When three or more babies accompany one adult or a child (tickets are required for the third and any additional babies).
2. When a baby or infant occupies his or her own reserved seat, Green Car seat, or berth.
3. When a baby travels alone.
4. When a baby travel as a group.

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